

Absolutely — **purple** is a useful secondary polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “...the soft layers of blue, green, and **purple**...”

Here **purple** is the literal colour sense. But the word also has important extensions in **royalty/status, ornate writing, politics in some countries, and related forms such as purplish**.

Word family: **purple / purplish**

Base word: purple

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective (形容詞)

Related adjective: purplish

Meaning in your passage: **purple = the colour between red and blue — 紫色 ; 紫色的**

Your phrase:

> “the soft layers of blue, green, and **purple**”

Here **purple** means:

> **a colour formed conceptually between red and blue, ranging from reddish-purple to bluish-purple.**

繁體中文 :

介乎紅色與藍色之間的一系列紫色色調 ; 紫色

Natural translation:

> “the soft layers of blue, green, and purple”

「柔和交疊的藍、綠、**紫色**層次」

So here:

> **purple = 紫色**

1. **purple = the colour — 紫色**

The core noun meaning.

Practice 1

> “Purple is one of her favourite colours.”

「**紫色**是她最喜歡的顏色之一。」

Practice 2

> “The painting contains several shades of purple.”

「這幅畫包含幾種不同的**紫色色調**。」

****purple = 介乎紅與藍之間的一系列顏色****

2. ****purple = purple-coloured — 紫色的****

The adjective use.

Practice 3

> “She wore a ****purple**** dress.”

「她穿了一條****紫色的****裙子。」

Practice 4

> “The sky turned purple at sunset.”

「日落時天空變成了****紫色****。」

****purple — adjective = 呈紫色色調的****

3. ****purple = bruised / discoloured purple — 紫黑的；瘀紫的****

A common body/appearance use.

Practice 5

> “His arm turned ****purple**** after the injury.”

「他的手臂受傷後變得****瘀紫****。」

Practice 6

> “She had a purple bruise on her leg.”

「她腿上有一塊**紫黑色瘀傷**。」

purple = 因瘀傷、缺氧或血液積聚而呈現紫黑色

4. **purple = associated with royalty/nobility — 皇室的；尊貴的**

A major historical/cultural extension.

Because purple dye was historically expensive in many societies, **purple** became strongly associated with royalty and high status.

Practice 7

> “Purple was traditionally associated with **royalty**.”

「紫色傳統上與**皇室 / 尊貴地位**有關。」

Practice 8

> “The ruler wore purple robes as a sign of status.”

「統治者穿著紫色長袍，以象徵**尊貴地位**。」

purple — symbolic = 象徵皇室、權力、尊貴或高地位

5. **the purple = royal rank / imperial power (文學 / 歷史) — 皇權；帝位**

A historical/literary noun use.

Practice 9

> “He was born to the **purple**.”

「他出身於**皇室 / 帝王之家**。」

Practice 10

> “The phrase once referred to imperial rank and power.”

「這個說法過去指**帝位 / 皇權**。」

****the purple = 皇室地位、帝王身份或皇權****

Register:

* historical

* literary

* not everyday modern English

Useful for recognition, but secondary.

6. ****purple prose = 華麗浮誇的文筆；過度雕琢的文字****

A very useful fixed expression.

Practice 11

> “The novel is full of ****purple prose****.”

「這本小說充滿****華麗而浮誇的文筆****。」

Practice 12

> “The description becomes purple prose when every sentence is overloaded with adjectives.”

「如果每句話都塞滿形容詞，描寫就會變成****過度華麗浮誇的文字****。」

****purple prose = 過度華麗、做作、堆砌辭藻的寫作文風****

Usually negative.

7. ****purple passage = 華麗段落；特別鋪張的文字段落****

A related literary expression.

Practice 13

> “The essay contains a few ****purple passages****.”

「這篇文章有幾段****辭藻特別華麗的段落****。」

Practice 14

> “Critics felt the purple passages distracted from the story.”

「評論者認為那些**過度華麗的段落**削弱了故事本身。」

purple passage = 一段特別華麗、甚至顯得過火的文字

8. **purple = politically mixed between red and blue (特定政治語境) — 紫色的；兩派勢均力敵的**

This is a modern domain-specific use, especially in U.S. political language where red and blue symbolize major parties.

Practice 15

> “The state is often described as **purple**.”

「這個州常被形容為政治上呈**紫色 / 兩派勢均力敵**。」

Practice 16

> “The district has become more purple over time.”

「這個選區逐漸變得**兩大政治陣營支持度較均衡**。」

purple — political = 紅、藍兩種政治陣營的支持度較接近 / 混合

This meaning is jurisdiction-specific and should be interpreted by context.

9. **purplish = somewhat purple — 帶紫色的；略呈紫色的**

A useful related adjective.

Practice 17

> “The clouds had a **purplish** colour.”

「雲層帶有一種**微紫色**。」

Practice 18

> “The flower is pink with purplish edges.”

「這朵花是粉紅色，邊緣**略帶紫色**。」

purplish = 有一點紫色，但不是純正 / 明顯紫色

Important distinction: **purple vs violet**

These overlap, but are not always identical.

purple

broad everyday colour category between red and blue.

violet

often a more specific bluish-purple shade, and also the colour term used for the short-wavelength end of visible light.

So:

> purple = 廣義紫色

> violet = 紫羅蘭色 / 偏藍紫

In everyday English, boundaries vary.

Important distinction: **purple vs lilac**

purple

broad and often stronger/darker.

lilac

a pale light purple.

> purple dress

> = 紫色裙

> lilac wall

> = 淡紫 / 丁香紫牆面

Important distinction: **purple vs lavender**

lavender

usually a pale, soft bluish-purple.

purple

broader category.

> lavender = 薰衣草紫

> purple = 紫色

Important distinction: **purple vs magenta**

purple

typically lies conceptually between red and blue.

magenta

is a strong reddish-purple / purplish-red colour.

They can overlap visually but are not synonymous.

Important distinction: **purple — colour vs symbolic royalty**

Literal:

> “a purple flower”

= 紫色花朵

Symbolic:

> “purple as a symbol of royalty”

= 紫色象徵皇室 / 尊貴

Same colour, different cultural meaning.

Important distinction: **purple prose vs beautiful prose**

beautiful prose

= 文筆優美

purple prose

= 過度華麗、刻意炫技，通常帶負面評價

So **purple prose** is not praise.

Important distinction: **purple prose vs poetic prose**

poetic prose

can be elegant and literary.

purple prose

suggests excess:

too many ornate words, metaphors, adjectives, etc.

> poetic = 詩意的

> purple = 浮誇華麗的

Important distinction: **purple vs purplish**

purple

= clearly purple.

purplish

= somewhat purple / tinged with purple.

> purple sky

> = 紫色天空

> purplish sky
> = 略帶紫色的天空

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **purple — noun colour** = 紫色
* **purple — adjective colour** = 紫色的
* **purple — bruise/discolouration** = 紫黑 / 瘀紫的
* **purple — royalty symbolism** = 皇室 / 尊貴象徵
* **the purple** = 皇權 / 帝位 (歷史 / 文學)
* **purple prose** = 華麗浮誇的文筆
* **purple passage** = 過度華麗的段落
* **purple — political** = 紅藍兩派支持度混合 / 勢均力敵
* **purplish** = 略帶紫色的

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
purple — noun	介乎紅色與藍色之間的一系列紫色色調
purple — adjective	呈現紫色色調的
purple — bruised	因瘀傷、血液積聚等而呈紫黑色的
purple — symbolic	與皇室、權力、尊貴地位相關的象徵
the purple	皇室 / 帝王地位或皇權，歷史 / 文學用法
purple prose	辭藻堆砌、過度華麗而顯得做作的文筆
purple passage	特別華麗甚至過度鋪張的文字段落
purple — political	特定政治語境中兩大陣營支持度較均衡 / 混合的
purplish	帶有一些紫色、但不是明顯純紫色的

For your original phrase

> “...the soft layers of blue, green, and **purple**...”

The exact meaning is:

**purple = Monet 畫面中出現的紫色色調，與藍色和綠色柔和交疊，形成水面、倒影和光線的色彩層次。 **

Natural translation:

> **「柔和交疊的藍、綠、紫色色彩層次。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **purple colour** → 紫色
- > **purple bruise** → 紫黑色瘀傷
- > **purple as royalty** → 皇室 / 尊貴象徵
- > **purple prose** → 華麗浮誇的文筆
- > **purple passage** → 過度華麗的文字段落
- > **purple political area** → 兩派支持度較均衡的地區
- > **purplish** → 略帶紫色的